

# Resources

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**In general, you should start with the federal agency or information center for a topic, but then look at the commerce and small business offices for your state, which often have extra and necessary information and regulations.**

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## **Registering your business name**

Check that your proposed name is not too similar to an existing business by searching company registers in the relevant state/region.

### **US**

Choose your business name.  
[www.sba.gov/business-guide/launch-your-business/choose-your-business-name](http://www.sba.gov/business-guide/launch-your-business/choose-your-business-name)

### **Canada**

Choose and register your business name.  
[www.canada.ca/en/services/business/start/choosing-a-business-name-3.html](http://www.canada.ca/en/services/business/start/choosing-a-business-name-3.html)

## **Registering your business**

You may have to register your business with the government to make it a distinct legal entity.

### **US**

Register your business. How and where you need to register depends on your business structure and business location.  
[www.sba.gov/business-guide/launch-your-business/register-your-business](http://www.sba.gov/business-guide/launch-your-business/register-your-business)

### **Canada**

Register your business with the government.  
[www.canada.ca/en/services/business/start/register-with-gov.html](http://www.canada.ca/en/services/business/start/register-with-gov.html)

## **Setting up nonprofit organizations**

Nonprofit organizations may have different set-up requirements from conventional businesses.

### **US**

Starting a nonprofit organization  
[www.usa.gov/start-nonprofit](http://www.usa.gov/start-nonprofit)

### **Canada**

Creating a not-for-profit corporation  
[www.ic.gc.ca/eic/site/cd-dgc.nsf/eng/cs04970.html](http://www.ic.gc.ca/eic/site/cd-dgc.nsf/eng/cs04970.html)

## **Creating a business plan**

A business plan forms the foundation of a business. Templates can help in the efficient writing of a plan.

### **US**

Write your business plan—information and business templates  
[www.sba.gov/business-guide/plan-your-business/write-your-business-plan](http://www.sba.gov/business-guide/plan-your-business/write-your-business-plan)

### **Canada**

Assessing your readiness, choosing a business structure, market research, and writing a business plan  
[www.canada.ca/en/services/business/start/planning.html](http://www.canada.ca/en/services/business/start/planning.html)

## **Business licenses and permits**

Local and national permits and licenses may apply to your business.

### **US**

Apply for federal and state licenses and permits.  
[www.sba.gov/business-guide/launch-your-business/apply-licenses-permits](http://www.sba.gov/business-guide/launch-your-business/apply-licenses-permits)

### **Canada**

Permits, licenses, and regulations  
[www.canada.ca/en/services/business/permits.html](http://www.canada.ca/en/services/business/permits.html)

## **Business insurance requirements**

There are no national general requirements for business insurance, so check state and local requirements as well as requirements or suggestions by industry association.

### **US**

A guide to types of business insurances  
[www.sba.gov/business-guide/launch-your-business/get-business-insurance](http://www.sba.gov/business-guide/launch-your-business/get-business-insurance)